Contact Staff Movements

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(occasionally with other peoples text.)

Contact Staff: *Spinning or Manipulating a staff without holding it with your hand/s. (Specifically without gripping it using the palm of your hand.) Where the staff comes into contact with your body and rolls / wraps around it.*

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Introduction

This book is going to attempt to teach you contact staff, and failing that, hopefully you will have a better grasp of the range of movements possible, how to learn them and some interesting concepts to do with staff manipulation.

I know it's hard to understand textual descriptions, but I've tried to be systematic, so if you try to understand a little, hopefully you'll get a lot out of it.

General Info.

Contact Staff requires patience and a hard head to learn. But it will help if you have a good long (1.5) staff with decent weights on the end. It is perfectly possible to do most of this moves with a devilstick, but they will be easier to learn with a long stick. (I'm not dissing devilsticks. Indeed if you can do the move with a devilstick it will be super smooth with a long staff.)

Contact Staff is much like poi, you should be very confident of a move before you try it on fire, and you should have practised with the fire staff you are going to use, not just a practise staff. You should take pains to find out how hot the metal of your staff gets, so that you can determine how close to the wick you can grip it safely.

For this guide a lot of experience with basic moves is assumed. Most importantly, Figure of Eights. (Is there any other move?)

Also, for some moves (Especially moves that involve catching/rolling over the back of the hand) You might consider sweatbands or fingerless gloves as a method of bruise prevention. Back of the hand bruises hurt a lot and aren't highly visible, two things you don't want in a bruise. (Well the first one maybe)

Wrists, belly's, backs and shoulders may get sore and may need to be more flexible to do some moves. Warm them up!

HOW TO AVOID HEAD INJURIES.

Learn slowly.

The longer it takes you to learn something, the longer it will take you to forget it. (It took me about a day to learn my subject for my university finals, and I've forgotten it all already... :) No seriously, don't feel you have to learn quickly. I didn't have this wonderful site to learn from when I was learning, it took me about a thousand times longer to learn anything, cos all I had to go on was a super fast video of a single move done on fire, from a poor angle with practically no lighting of the spinners body. That and a baton

twirling video with the resolution of the first camera phone. You'll learn faster than me, isn't that enough for you? And learning slowly has it's advantages, if you take everything in your stride, you'll hit yourself on the head less.

Cheat.

Yes! Cheat! Cheating is a great way to learn moves. Like the Contact Weave is a cheating version of a fishtail, and it gives you a good idea of the hand movement for a fishtail. Or just gently giving the staff a push in the right direction in the middle of a move to get it to go right. Eventually you won't need these little cheats, and by using them, you'll have avoided a lot of metal toward face based injuries...

Bail.

Don't think a move is going to come out right? Don't finish it then. Get the staff away from you as fast as possible. It may not look good or gain you the respect of your peers, but you won't have concussion, so all is well.

Do it slowly.

Do the move as slowly as possible. (Though contact usually requires some small amount of momentum) This will force you to learn the move better, and if it does hit you, it won't hurt as much.

Learn the end before the start.

This is also a very important principle. For most contact moves, it's a good thing to learn the end of the move before the start. The steve for instance is a prime example. Learning the end means that when you try the difficult part, joining the start and the end up, though you might be a bit flaky on the start (since you're learning it) at least you know where you want it to go, and once you're over the hard part, it's smooth sailing. It'll also allow you to recover a wobbly start better, cos you'll have more experience of where you want it to be. All in all this is just the best way to learn.

Disclaimer:

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In other words: I'm not perfect. Also, you will probably hit yourself and it won't be my fault... :) (Sorry, I just like disclaimers.)

Concepts.

Spinning Concepts:

The centre of the staff. Find out where the centre of your staff is and MARK IT! (And make it bright, you'll need to see it at night.) Sweeping generalisation: Most contact moves are basically keeping some part of your body under the centre. Mark it, so you know where that is. Generally pulling off a clean contact move means you correctly placed the centre of the staff on a body part, or that the centre point took the correct path. (Even if it wasn't onto of your body the whole time.)

Falling. The staff falls off your body after a while when you're not holding it. This is an effect of gravity. We love gravity. You'll get a feel for how it will fall off after a while, and be able to match speed with it to catch it. This will save on bruises. (I know you like bruises, but invariably they will be on body parts that don't bruise well.) Maybe you can make a circular motion with a body part to confuse the falling stick and make it think it wants to hang around in space for a while, so that you can get it on another body part. Go for it I say. Maybe you will find interesting places to catch the stick, maybe you will find interesting ways to catch it. (BTB, into Fishtails, on the foot / leg....)

Planes! See above. However, some moves will be slightly off plane all the time. These will be to begin with - all moves. Then you will be able to clean up the vertical moves. The horizontal moves are harder, cos it be harder to see how clean the planes are. Then you will discover that for some moves perfect clean planes are nigh on impossible. For example: Hand roll: Easy to get clean, no impediment to plane of staff; Halo roll: The staff has to be slightly off plane (Not much!) for you to get under it's centre. Otherwise your back and the staff would be in exactly the same plane. Not so good.

Look at the staff! Many moves require you to dip your head to let the staff roll over the back of your neck, or to get your head out of the way. That is not an excuse to stop looking at the staff. For gods sake! You might be doing these moves with fire! Why would you not want to look at it!

The actual reason to keep an eye on the staff: The staff is in contact with your body, but touch receptors can only tell you so much, and indeed you should learn to listen closely to what they are saying, but you're eyes can tell you loads too. Keep looking at the staff for as long as possible in any contact move. Watch that centre line!

The staff rotates. This is what we call *spinning*. It will also *roll*. Like a rolling pin. When a staff rotates around a point (like an arm) it is said to 'wrap' that arm. When a staff rolls down an arm, it's called a 'roll'. (blah blah blah.) Sometimes the staff will both roll and spin at the same time. (See the Steve) These are some of the most fun moves. The staff can also 'step'. This is where the centre of the staff is not supported by a body part; while the staff spins, alternate sides of the staff step on the body part as the staff works

it's way along. There aren't many of these moves. They must be hard. Some moves look like they should be stepping, but are actually wrapping and rolling, like the Angel Roll. (Can you do anti-spin moves? Can you, can YOU? Can you do anti-roll moves? Well? What about anti-step moves?)

Spin, anti-spin static and dynamic. (For examples see back of the neck spins for spin/anti-spin and Steve's for static/dynamic)

The staff spins in one direction. (At a time) In a contact move you can turn in the same direction of the spin, this generally makes the staff feel 'slower' and you have more time in the move. This would probably be called turning with the spin.

Anti-Spin is where you turn against the spin of the staff, speeding up the movement of the staff relative to you and forcing you to do the move quicker. This can also make the staff appear more stationary to an audience. (wow! You have an audience?) Anti-spin is good! And looks really nang! But it is hard, due to you have to be doing hard contact moves in an extra hard way, and faster to boot.

Dynamic moves - just what you think, ones where the staff spins. Static moves, ones where the staff doesn't. Static Steve vs. Steve and all that. Can all Dynamic moves be done statically? And vice versa... Can all turning moves be done with anti-spin? Vertical anti-spin moves maybe? (Maybe not, vertical anti-spin moves, with a 5 foot metal staff, on fire, in the middle of the meadows, at night, with my reputation?! :eek:) Can all vertical moves be done horizontally and vice versa????

Contact Concepts:

Continuity. You can try and go as long as possible without using your hands by doing as many contact tricks as you can string together. This is not the point of contact. The point of contact is looking good and keeping the flow, not forcing it.

Behind the Back. Yes you can enter and exit a lot of moves Behind The Back. (BTB) Don't get too carried away. Nothing ugly or falling over like.

Prayer. Indeed some moves you can do with your hands together. Some people want to show their audience, (!an they get audiences!) that they *really* aren't using their hands! Keeping your palms together can do this, as can making a fist, some other hand postures and maybe even waving... Hands together, or 'Prayer' moves really are fun, and surprising hard for just keeping your hands together... Here's one I made earlier: Oh no it isn't anyway. Try this at home: Find what contact moves you can do with your hands together!

Dance / Movement Concepts:

Flow. Flow is that indefinable quality that makes a performance good. (It's what makes a melody good, what makes a rap album good, what makes a skilled traceur good and so on.) It's very hard to achieve and hard to give tips on. Practise your tricks and then remember to play then flowing will happen gradually then suddenly.

Completeness of moves and journeys. In the moves section there are

many moves that are referred to as 'component' moves. This is not just a name, this is what they are. For example a neck wrap and the Steve. The Steve is the full move. Doing a neck wrap and then a arm roll is not as pleasing because it is not complete. It's missing the first half... Journeys are a natural tendency to want the staff to travel around the body.

Plane changes. Using stops and contact to change planes is usually the best thing you can do. (usually in that order.)

Stops. Stops are very useful especially when you use the power of gravity to do the stop for you and don't force the staff. Thinking about flow, stops are like beats. (as are the letting go and regripping of a staff in and out of a contact move) Use them to make a nice rhythm. Where's your melody going to come from? You're other hand? Your face? Your body? Your staff? All of the above?

Stance. Remember it. Think about your footwork, what are your feet doing? Stand up straight! Correct your posture! What's your other arm doing? Is that a dinosaur hand I see? Pah! You took a step after the move? What were you off balance? You get points off for that in gymnastics y'know. Are you just stood there? MOVE!

> ***You all ought to know: This is an ellipsis: '...', it is not a full stop, it is it's own bit of punctuation, therefore to use an ellipsis at the end of a sentence you ought to a put a full stop after it, like this....***

Clarifications:

- **Off centre grip:** a three quarter grip, or a far grip all refer to the same thing.
- **Forward spinning:** In wall plane, end comes up from your feet, spins across body, leaves to go away from your body. (Or Clockwise for a big clock in front of you for the right hand, anti-clockwise for the left hand.)
- **Reverse spinning:** opposite of above.
- **Inward spinning:** for the left hand, wall plane, clockwise, or reverse, for the right, anti-clockwise / reverse.
- **Outward spinning:** Basically another name for Forward.
- **Front side:** Not BTB, contacted on the front of the body.
- **Long-arm:** Arms stay straight, locked out and long. Not Bent.
- **Back of Neck:** The back of your neck, this may be referred to as just neck, or BoN.
- **Throat / Throat side:** The throat is obviously part of your neck, but for staffing purposes it's only the back of the neck that ever gets referred to as neck and the front is always throat or throat side.

Authors Notes:

I have tried to write the moves without reference to spinning direction, or right or left hands. I hope this explains things so that people can learn the moves in both directions, or in both hands. Learning all variations of a move is very important, especially in the vertical plane and definitely in horizontal. (Though I didn't think so to begin with. I've learned from my mistakes.) If I don't succeed in this aim, tell me and I will write directionated descriptions.

Things to Remember: Planes, Stance, body movement, foot work, and balance. What is the other arm doing? Dunnoe? Well sort it out.

Planes:

- **Wall Plane** - The vertical plane in front (and behind) of you, the staff is as if spinning on a wall in front of you.
- **Wheel Plane** - The plane to the side of you, as if the staff is a spoke of a wheel to either side of you.
- **Horizontal Plane** - Flat. Perfectly Flat in parallel to a perfectly flat ground. (Think helicopter blades)
- **45 Degree Plane** – Exactly between horizontal and vertical. Always with the side that is tilted up on the one side of your body, (not rotating, like a wobbling plate.)

All spinning should be conducted with perfect perpendicular-ness to whatever it should be perpendicular to. You maybe think planes are not important, you are *WRONG!* Planes are important, if only to teach you to do tricks perfectly, then you can go and do non-plane stuff. Learn to walk before you run like.

When we refer to good planes, we call them 'clean'. One can 'clean' up ones planes. Otherwise you might have 'scrappy' planes.

DEFINITIONS:

Types of Spin:

Anti-Turn
Imagine the staff spinning on your back, you're going to turn against the spin of the staff. So the staff rotates in one direction, and you rotate in the opposite direction.

Anti-Spin
You're spinning he staff in your hand if you make a big circle with your arm, your more than likely to make the circle in the same direction as the staff is rotating, but you don't have to, if your arm, (or any body part that can make a circle) is tracing the opposite direction circle to that which the staff is making, this is anti-spin.

Spin
To turn and or move your arm WITH the spin of the staff. IE: In the same direction. Generally easier.

Super-Spin
To trace a circle with your arm (enter limb here) that moves FASTER than the spin of the staff. So they are both going in the same direction, but your arm is outpacing the staff's rotation. (Like clock hands.) [There must therefore be Super-Anti-Spin then, you're thinking, I guess there is, but it must be very hard.]

Super-Turn
Turning around in the same direction as the staff is rotating, but faster than the staff is turning.

Beats
= One circle of the staff. Note one end of the staff, turn it till it reaches it's starting position. This is one beat.

Types of Contact:

Spin
To have the staff spinning on the centre point supported by some part of your body.

Wrap
To have the staff wrapping around a body part. Generally starting with the centre point not on the body part and the centre point being supported on the top surface of the body part for only one moment during the wrap, then attempting to fall off the other side.

Roll
For the staff to roll down it's one axis of... er... rolling.

Stall
For a very off centre point of the staff to be supported and the application of gravity to the centre point to bring the staff to momentarily rest in a horizontal position, seemingly supported by the off centre point, then to fall back the way it came.

Step

A cross of a spin and a stall. For the staff's two ¾ points to alternately step onto body parts and be supported there, before the spin brings the other ¾ point around to be supported by another body part.

Types of Turn:

Backside

Imagine you have a line, and that your feet are shoulder width apart on it. You're going to rotate around one foot and bring the other behind it to step backwards onto the line again, but facing the opposite direction. When you turn, your butt is leading your body, you back is going first, as if in reverse and your looking where you came from. Hence the term backside.

Frontside

Imagine you have a line, and that your feet are shoulder width apart on it. You're going to rotate around one foot and bring the other in front of it to step over onto the line again, but facing the opposite direction. When you turn, you're looking where your going. Your front is facing the turning, hence the term: frontside.

Moves.

Hand Wraps.

1) Hand wrap 4 ways.
The basic hand wrap. First way: wall-plane, forwards, held a hands span away from the centre, knuckles up. Bring the staff into the crook of your arm. (By crook I mean twisting your wrist and forearm as if you were cradling a baby or small animal of some other kind. Basically so that your palm is facing up.) But it's not going to go fully into the crook (like you would do when doing a snake / double spin / shotgun etc.) instead you are going to let go of the staff (and it should roll outside of your thumb, over your wrist a little) and turn your hand quickly round (as the staff traverses the top of your hand) to grab it on the other side. If you did this right, you should end up gripping the staff in the same place. If not, you either gripped the staff a hands span away from the centre on the wrong side (My poor specification, swap sides.), or let it roll inside your thumb. This is the basic hand wrap and can be done in the other hand too (but obviously going in the other direction.), it can be done continuously, and indeed with double staffs. The other direction you can't do continuously as your hand travels up the staff to the wick generally.

2) 2 extra inefficient ways.
The first inefficient way, do the basic hand wrap, but let it roll inside your thumb so that your hand travels up the staff. This will hopefully put your hand in the correct position to start doing efficient hand wraps.
Do a travelling hand wrap but give it a little pop off the back of your hand so you can catch it in the centre again. This will stop it travelling.

3) Devilsticking.
Use some padding for learning this. Seen devil-stickers doing propeller with one control stick? Well you can do it too, with one hand!
Get the staff spinning, and some point start to whirl it round with just the back of your hand. This generally involves your hand going in small circle with the staff. The staff will try and fall when your hand is above the centre, but with practise this doesn't happen. Plus you should practise slowing down the staff, because speeding it up is easy and will get it out of control hence the dropping, but before the dropping, the uber sore smacking on the back of the hand.

4) Thumbs.
Thumbs may or may not be considered ugly by some, but they are darn useful. The thumb is going to be used to make a club/devil stick style trap for the staff between the thumb and the forearm. If you can work out this position, (holding the staff locked between thumb and forearm, no grip, your wrist has to be bent some.) statically, then you can practise getting into it dynamically. I find this generally involves spinning in reverse for the hand that's going to do the trap. Once trapped the staff can be carried all over the place in the trap.

5) Confusatron.
So previously a secret of Ninja Steve, I'm now going to tell you exactly what this entails. The first confusatron is to do a set of

hand wraps, and when your palms are facing each other, you very quickly cross your hands over the staff and pull them back again. (Yes, it's a purely visual move.) It's just made to look like something weird is happening.
The extended confusatron is a bit harder. Generally it's a good idea to pull off a confusatron beforehand, just to confuse people. Then after that the staff should continue to wrap over your hands and start to fall over the pinky side of one of your hands. At this point you have to whip that hand around and grab the staff in a thumb lock. this should give it enough impetus to continue around the hand wrap and some arm wraps if your feeling happy. The key is to keep the other arm (that doesn't do much) in the way, so nobody can see the tricky thumb lock, hence making people think it's magic, and confuse them.

6) Approving Steve's Ninja Pull-Out.
Hold the staff on the back of your hand in the centre, but not with your arm straight out, with your arm coming round over the staff down and under to your hand. (Kinda like you're making a strange YMCA dance position.) From here if you start to move your hand (reasonable fast) up and take it over your head and behind you, centrifugal force should keep the staff on your hand and it should end there but with your arm straight out behind you. You can also turn to face the staff during the movement. Also you have the staff turning. (Depending on the direction this will make it easier or harder.) Also You can pull the staff back into this position by doing the opposite.

7) Hand wraps above head. Behind body.
Hand wraps can indeed be done everywhere. Have fun!

8) Contact weave. And variations.
See Knoxious's Video.

Try spinning a simple figure of eight, with the staff gripped between your wrist. Now try to turn one of your hands so it's palm is facing the ground, and both hands stay level. You'll be doing the contact weave! Very simple, but still takes a little practise to get smooth.

Or alternately read this:

> Here is an alternate explanation of the contact weave by Rob.
>
> **two handed fishtails.**
> **A beautiful slow move that has helped me enormously in smoothing out my fishtails.**
>
> **put the staff on the backs of both hands to your right side. The hands should be approx 40cm apart on a 150cm staff... the hands will not move from this position with regards to the staff, so i will refer to the staff ends as the left hand end and right hand end...**
> **So the left hand end is pointing in front of you.**
> **lift the right hand end and drop the left hand end making 1/2 a revolution and moving both hands to the other side. this should end with the staff is the start position but on the other side of your body.... repeat but the other way.**
> **The second hand stabilises and makes fishtails easy... the movement of both hands is very very similar to the movement on one hand fishtails, hence why i use it as a practise.**
> **For backwards you use the same start position...only you lift the left hand end and drop the right hand end. make the half revolution. and tadaaa! you should be there or thereabouts.**

I find this very therapeutic. It can be done with most hand positions, fists, palms up, palms down, palms facing, knuckles facing, and crossed arms etc.

It's also very nice to do this above your head like a windmill, (from poi) or to really pull and push the staff (so it rolls) up to your elbow and back down. Extra beats can be put in with hand wraps, or by twisting up your arms further.

9) contact waist wrap.
Like the contact weave but done at your side with one arm crossed behind your back. More than that I can't say, cos I haven't learnt it yet.

10) contact weave BTB.
Much the same explanation as No. 9.

11) Buzzsaw weave.
Do a contact weave but at a three quarter length 'grip' and bring the short end inside your arm and then continue as usual.

12) Andre's Buzzsaw.
This is a buzz saw all in front of you. The staff spinning in wheel plane, but in front of your chest. How are you going to do such a thing with a 1.5 metre staff you say? Well hold it as one end, turn and hold it at the other. But that is not all, when the staff is coming far away and trying to hit your head but falling in front of your torso, or inwards, as some might call it, you can let gravity slide the staff down between your hands, so you can have both hands close together at one end, giving you greater control.

13) Palm holding.
Hold the staff between your palms, spin. Simple.

14) Windmills.
The contact weave can go up to a windmill (above and behind your head.) and down again, in various ways. Does require some coordination and belly showing. I know my explanations are getting pretty slack, but I wrote this last so my enthusiasm is not quite so enthusing.

15) Contact weave catch.
Knoxious said you can catch a throw with your arms crossed and immediately go into the contact weave. Not quite figured this one out yet but I say him do it, so it #must# be possible.

Neck Wraps.

1) Neck wraps.
One of the most basic contact moves, and one of the most important since it serves as a component part for so many others. Basically the staff is going to hit the neck horizontally, wrap around it, and then be caught by the same or the other hand as it spins onto the other shoulder. There are many variations on direction of spin, what hand puts it on, what hand takes it off, and ALL are possible and useful to learn. The most important thing when learning a neck wrap is to make sure the staff is absolutely horizontal, that you put it on close to your neck, that the centre point of the staff is on the centre of the back of your neck during the wrap and that the staff wraps to the other shoulder, not to falling off down the back or down the arm.

2) Extra spins.
Extra spins on the back of the neck or very important too. It is a slightly hard move to learn but worth it to give yourself extra flourishes in a contact move, extra time in a contact move and perhaps most importantly, it can help you recentre the staff on the back of your neck.

So the staff is going to do a neck wrap (Any way you like) and it's going to wrap to your far shoulder perfectly and be very close to your neck still. (Distance from neck and attempts to do extra spins can result in fun though. It probably perfectly possible to learn horizontal spins on shoulders and down arms.) You're still going to be watching the staff as it comes round, and you duck your head to let it pass over, but you WATCH it was as long as possible! Then you let it do it's extra rotation and come back to the side of the neck it was going to exit on anyway.

Shoulder blade shimmying can help this move. (Once you've practised a few times you'll understand the action and be able to use your shoulder blades to both recentre the staff and give it a tiny bit of spin) Plus when you get good, you should be able to do 4+ spins on the back of your neck. (While stood still as well) Extra spins while turning in the spin direction are easier and look pretty cool anyway. Just find something to do with your arms.

3) Anti-spin.
Back of the neck spins with anti-spin turns are quite hard. You must be able to do 2 spins at least on the back of your neck while still before trying this. All you have to do is turn in the opposite direction. This will speed up the spin of the staff relative to you, so you have to be fast on the ducking and watching business. Any grip on the staff at this point will oppose your movement, as your body has to slide underneath it.

4) Neck Pinches. Horizontal + Vertical.
Neck pinches are not the most attractive move but very useful. The basic idea is that the staff is going to either be pinched between the neck and the shoulder, or that the arm is going to be raised so the staff is trapped between the raised arm and the neck. The second is better looking, but can only be done horizontally. The first requires a lot of head tilting to the side to trap the staff.

First of all vertical: From any neck wrap or even just placing the staff on the shoulder, it can be trapped by raising the arm. The staff can then be made to reverse direction, and gone into a throat or neck wrap. It can be carried in this position and if you spin

around, you will impart spin to the staff and when you let it go it will be spinning faster. Or you can do static neck wraps by turning the back of your neck into the staff and then getting the other side onto your shoulder.

> Here Rob explains how to do a Horizontal Neck Pinch: (Though a shoulder grab is a good name.)
>
> **shoulder grabs . ultimate for keeping a trick going and stupidly simple.**
> **Put the staff on your left shoulder(or right shoulder. it doesn't matter.) lift the arm adjacent. turn round and round and round. lower your arm. let the staff roll down the arm(or if going the other way then around the neck and down the other arm) to your waiting hand. tadaaa!**

4.5) Ninja Neck Locks
There is also a non-standard neck lock. (this is most definitely a lock, not a pinch.) This is the ninja lock, named after ninja dave. But it also transfers into Lucero's from baton twirling.

So you're going to trap it against the back of your head and your shoulder. (I have to raise my arm to do this, but you really only need to raise your shoulder.) The previous pinch I was talking about was between the throat and the shoulder. So this lock is essentially the opposite.

Pushing your head back will cause the staff to start turning and try and swing into your head, so you have to dusk pretty quickly to let it pass. (it's essentially wanting to a halo roll.) Immediately once it passes over your head you can lock it again, but see the next description for that.

This move can also be done vertically.

4.6) Luceros.
A move invented / discovered by the Baton Twirler Annette Lucero. It's basically continuous neck locks (the ninja kind). It has plenty of variations, doing it across the throat instead of the back of the neck. Or to make it prettier you can try and eliminate the very sudden stop and gently turn the staff to the opposite direction while it's doing a circle at your shoulder. You do have to turn your torso a fair bit to do it nice and cleanly.

If your feeling even more balletic, you can hold your hands in prayer above your head and do this movement, or do backstroke or frontstoke, or indeed, anything you please...

5) Vertical Neck wraps.
Just what they say on the tin. The head is bent down as if nodding. And the staff wraps over the back of the neck. It will fall off again quite quickly so grab it swiftly. This is another important component move.

6) Variations on Vertical.
You can get into a vertical neck wrap in many ways. Here I'm going to explain a few of them. From a hand wrap, the staff should be on the back of your hand, you can bring it to your neck and do a neck wrap. Or alternatively you can do this and turn slightly to catch BTB. Even more alternatively when the staff is on the back of your neck you can make a very quick 360 turn and the staff should end up where it started. (Or a little further down your arm, depending on how smooth you are.)

Vertical neck wraps are obviously very related to vertical steeves. Using the back of the hand method they can be put into elbow wraps too.

7) Full Neck wraps.
Full Neck wraps - Horizontal. Do the back of the neck wrap, then front neck wrap then really trying to massage it round onto the back again. Can require some strange head/neck movements. Mine usually spit fire out onto my shoulder after the throat wrap and I have to raise my arm to get it back onto the neck.

Leaning back is required and encouraged, as is hula style neck movement. The centre point of your staff will go a long way off-centre if it doesn't slide round your neck so try and get it to slide, if ya wanna do it continuously.

People can also do Vertical Full neck wraps from vertical neck pinches. This is hard and requires a lot of force pushed into the staff from the pinch, to get it all the way round.

8) Continuous neck wraps / halo rolls. (Cont. Spins on back of neck)
So do a neck wrap, and turn around with the staff balanced on the ending shoulder of the neck wrap. Do a full 360. This should be pretty easy. Now after your comfortable with that, watch the staff and duck your head and let it pass over your head. You'll need to slow the turn a little for this to happen. This is the halo part of the movement. Pop your head back up again, and keep watching the staff, it should be on your other shoulder now. Keep turning. When your ready, let it wrap your neck. You'll need to slow up again for this to happen, and lower your shoulders. Now, you know what to do huh? Duck your head again and let it halo... and so on... all while turning.

Once that pretty easy, you can experiment with how much turn you need to put in there before you do the movements, till your just turning with the staff spinning... Also on the first shoulder. (the shoulder before it does the neckwrap) you can touch your cheek to the staff and push it around, speeding it up. Doing this movement a lot can slow it down, and this is a cheeky and easy way to maintain momentum.

Stops n' Stalls.

1) With and without force.
With the staff spinning fast (ish) and you put a body part in the way to force the staff to stop, I would call this a STOP. When you use gravity to stop the staff, I would call this a STALL. The staff stops either way, but this naming makes sense to me.
Remember Kids, you don't just have to use gravity to stall the staff, you can you it to start it spinning too!

2) Armpit stops.
Spinning reverse wall plane, the staff does half a hand wrap to be spinning on the back of your hand, the leading end comes in under your arm and stops in your armpit. You can easily hold the staff here indefinitely, but you can also come out of it in the other direction by applying a little force. The staff should do an arm wrap on the exit, and you can take it off in several contacty sort of ways, some of which involve wall plane fishtails.

3) Back of hand devilstick stall.
As the staff is spinning, usually in a devil stick propeller or coming down from a throw, catch on the back of the hand, far far off centre, this should stall the staff. (matching speeds should be a definite.) Then you can go into opposite direction propeller or anything else appropriate.

Body Part Spins.

1) Back spins.
A horizontal spin on your back. (You're bent over.) Various ways to get into this, the easiest just placing it on your back with your hand.... Or you can do it from a Steve, or from an elbow trap, or from a cradle or a nice across the body sweep of the staff....

Here is an alternate explanation of the move:

horizontal back spins.

These can be done quite simply. its just a matter of choosing your way in and way out. one I use most of all is the entrance under the left arm.

Holding the staff in your right hand on the centre, spinning anticlockwise and horizontally, place the staff on your left shoulder, about 6-8 inches off centre. lean right and lift your left arm. give the staff a push and lean forward, head down. the staff should spin on your back. normally the first few times t will just simply go across to the right side where it can be removed with your right hand.

With a bit of practise and knowledge of your own staff and back, you will find exits all over the place: left shoulder, right shoulder, low on your right side, up onto your head(I get this about 1 in 20, but it conveniently goes to either shoulder if you get it wrong…)

2) Belly spins.
A horizontal spin on the belly.

3) Head spins.
As you're going into it watch the centre of the staff for as long as possible. Got it to spin on your head? Try turning with the staff, in the opposite direction etc. Horizontal, again.

Here is a better explanation by Rob:

head spins

I learned this one early on and still use it nearly every burn i do as a play...

Hold the staff slightly off centre in your right hand with a couple of extra inches showing in on the thumb side...

Spin the staff horizontally and anticlockwise..if you go from a standing start it will probably only make a 1/2 revolution before being placed onto your head.

Make sure you look at the centre of the staff as it approaches your head... and make sure it is coming in COMPLETELY horizontal. look forwards as the staff goes onto your head and try to keep very still and balanced(you, not the staff). if it has gone on cleanly then you will definitely get 1/2 a revolution, and probably more. first few goes just try for the half revolution. i generally get 1 or 1 1/2 but on good days can manage 3 or 4. very good days that is.

Take the staff off your head with your left hand, as this way it falls comfortably into the hand(if you try with your right the trick not only feels difficult but looks untidy as it is much less symmetrical.)

4) Palm spins.
A horizontal spin on the palm of your hand, your palm facing up. Finger drumming can be used to keep up the speed of the staff. This move can be done vertically with more of a grip. It's very hard to

describe however. The grip part is the thumb as the fingers kind of drum the staff around and alternately realise when the thumbs gripping and grip when the thumbs released. (Canes your forearms....) You can also do a similar spin on the back of your hand, but without the control of a palm-spin. Plus it's a little more bouncer too, and easy to go into and out of throws with.

5) All others.
With all body part spins, having the centre on the body part is most important, otherwise it will start to step.

Wraps.

1) Belly wraps.

Here Rob explains how to do a belly wrap.

simple waist wrap

Hold the staff in your left hand about 15cm off centre.

spin anticlockwise and horizontal all the way round to the back so your left hand is nearly touching your right hip. at the same time put your right hand BTB so it is nearly touching your left hip.

Release the staff so it wraps round your waist(belly/tummy/stomach/pot[in my case]) and it should go into your right hand.

2) Back wraps.
The opposite of the above. The staff wraps your back and your hands are crossed over your belly. Belly and back wraps can be done continuously alternately.

3) Leg variations.
Yes you can wrap your leg. (Devil stick style) See the Other section for more footwork.
Plus you can do belly and back wraps around your legs.

4) One handed.
Belly and back wraps can be done one handed. (this is a baton-twirler thing) So that hand that did all the stretching has to whip round and catch it again. (Can also be done with small throws instead of wraps, but since that isn't contact, we don't discuss it here... Shhhh.)

5) Baton Twirler styles.
Baton Twirlers are both nuts, and very flexible. They can do back of the neck wraps in the vertical plane, but BTB, so the staff wraps with you looking upward, you hands feeding and grabbing behind the head.
Baton Twirlers can usually bring their legs up to their heads, so they can do neck and foot wraps simultaneously. Hmmmm. Nice.

6) Vertical belly wraps, diablo style.
You know it makes sense, lean back and do a vertical belly wrap. Or lean forward and do a vertical back wrap. Groovy.

Shoulder Moves.

1) Shoulder Wraps.
Shoulder wraps are simply when the staff wraps your shoulder / top of your arm. Mostly done vertically, these can be done all ways, with

slightly varying degrees of difficulty, but are generally quite easy. However they are a very important component move for loads of other movements.

The staff should be held off centre either in the hand of the arm whose shoulder your going to wrap, or the other one. If it's the same hand, bring the staff in and under your arm pit so your hand is twisted up and very much squished into your armpit before releasing. The objective is to get the centre line over the top of your shoulder.

The other normal entrance is to wrap the shoulder starting with the staff in the other hand, just placing it under the armpit and getting your head out of the way.

Can also be done in reverse, but with less need to think about the entrance.

Can be caught with either hand. Experiment, you might find something crazy and hard.

2) Mounts.
Mounts are just names of ways to get the staff on your shoulder, you can come across the body, from BTB and all sorts, same hand other hand, armpit, across the back, these can be done as wraps, or as the start of a longer series of contact moves.

3) Shoulder Carries.
These are one beat turning carries, like illusions, but actually contact moves. Just get the staff to your shoulder and turn with it on that same shoulder. The staff should do the typical up and down wobble of all 1 beat turns. You can then learn this in the other direction and the other shoulder, and join them up using halo rolls! Yay! Remember, this is a vertical move, if it slows up to much it may become horizontal - don't do it!

[Nx?]'s shoulder mount drill:

a useful drill.

shoulders: forwards spinning right hand takes the staff under the left armpit and across your back to the right shoulder.

as it rolls forward off the right shoulder catch with the left hand,

bring again with left hand across the back from left to right and rolling forwards over the right shoulder,

catch in left hand again but this time put the staff under the right armpit and over the right shoulder, it doesn't cross the back.

catch with right hand now and take it over the right shoulder again from the right and catch in an elbow lock.

so the full thing goes: across the back with right, across with left, over the shoulder left, over the shoulder right to elbow lock. repeat but with other hands!

4) Elbow Traps to Shoulder Wraps

Holding the staff off-centre in your elbow pit, with the long end away from your body, by turning and releasing the staff with enough momentum, you can force the staff to wrap your shoulder from there. It's quite awkward and sore to start with but perfectly doable. If you whip your hand around fast enough you can re-enter another trap after the shoulder wrap.

The Fishtail Family.

1) Forward.

Here is an explanation of how to do them:

Fishtails: Forward

Path of the staff

The path that the staff travels is like when you kayak, each end of the staff stays on its side. As a starting point it is helpful to hold the staff like a paddle as if you where kayaking with both hands on the staff. I find fishtails are easier to do on the side of your body as the hand movements to stop the staff from hitting yourself are smaller. After having paddled in front of yourself try paddling on the side of your body.

Hand movement

Now that you have an idea as to where the staff has to move you can practise the hand movement. with your palm facing down move your hand in a half pipe shape. When your palm is facing directly down to the ground this should coincide with when the staff is parallel (well close to) with the ground. When your hand is coming from the right hand side to the left hand side the staff end on the right side of your body with be furthest away from you as visa versa.

If the staff is parallel to the ground and your hand is not the staff will go sliding off, be aware it will do so quite quickly and if you have a grippy grip its like carpet burn without the carpet.

You want the middle of the staff to be as close possible to the middle of the back of your hand/wrist to make the movement as balanced as possible.

Speed

Try to do the move as slowly as you can as it is very easy to hit yourself with this movement. There is a rhythm to the movement, just remember that if you do it fast you will have to move your hand very fast to keep up. If you do it to slow the staff will stall.

Starting the fishtail

The way shown in the video is roll the staff over the back of the hand, so that the staff rolls from your little finger end of the hand to the thumb.

I find that doing a figure 8 to the side of the body holding the staff with both hands flows into the fishtail nicely. Make sure that you position your hands so that when you do the back hand roll the middle of the staff will be close to in the middle of your wrist.

Steps to learning the move

1. Practise the kayaking motion
2. Practise just the hand motion
3. Do the hand motion and hold the staff on your hand using your other hand
4. Practise doing the palm roll and taking the staff to the opposite side of your body on the back of your hand
5. Practise the palm roll over to the other side and back again in the fishtail
6. Do 5. and repeat without the palm roll

2) Reverse.
Try the reverse of above. This is an easier movement as you can lock the staff against the forearm. Typically there will be one transition for each hand that is particularly hard. Practise more.

Firstly get your hands and put them in the position a Christian would pray in and a Japanese person would bow with and a b-boy would stretch their wrists with. Take one hand away and keep your other hand in the exact same position. This straight hand, but pulled back position is the one you want for reverse fishtails. (I'm teaching fishtails on the wrists cos they are easiest.) So your arm and hand should form an L shape. And you have to keep it like this through the entire fishtail.

Right get a staff, put the centre point on your wrist, with the hand still in that position. Horizontally, use your hand to push the staff one way, then the other, so it locks against the back of your hand and your forearm. Then push it the other way and lock it again and so on. These are the locks you'll use to control the reverse fishtail, to speed it up, get it back in plane and generally salvage it.

To connect up the pieces: You can use the contact weave to get a feel for it, or hold it with your other hand to get a feel for it.

The trick to a reverse fishtail is the bounce. It's not quite a figure of eight motion I make with my arm. I make a figure of eight, but also carve a small hill out of the air, that my hand always goes over, never through. This is the bounce part.

Also try each side of the fishtail on it's own to get a feel for it, then link them up using the methods above.

Remember that your hand has to stay up, it's turning to the side a little and your raised hand is stopping the staff from flying off. It's redirecting it to come back the other way. Your hand should always be 'in the way' and the staff to stop it flying away from you.

3) Extra Beat.
One half of the extra beat comes from inverting the staff in the manner of an armpit stop, but instead fishtailing it out. On the other half the elbow is bent and your hand fishtails above your shoulder.

4) Foot.
Very hard. Again reverse should be easier. I think the name gave the move away really. Make sure to drop, put, throw the staff onto your foot right, as your toes probably won't have much chance of correcting your errors.

5) Elbow.
Baton Twirler move. If you are doing an elbow wrap, in the second half, instead of letting it wrap over your upper arm and fall, you can twist the second hand around and grab the staff, immediately turning 180 degrees to the side that staff was going. Then you can hand wrap and do the same elbow wrap to grab back the way. This will give you the feeling of the elbow fishtail. It will be much faster than this however, and without the holding on. And yes indeed, it will take a LOT of practise.

6) Retarded.
Retarded fishtails. Imagine doing fishtails without the staff

crossing your body. (Wall plane) It would be like a devil stick propeller but without your hand following the circle of the staff. In fact, it would be a retarded fishtail. Where your hand/fingers, just pop in and out from underneath the centre point of the staff. Enough to keep it up and twirling and making your hand look like a retarded fish.

7) Above head.
Fishtails can be done above the head, in the manner of a normal, I'm going above and behind my head while holding onto the staff and then bring it in front. (Well technically on the other side of the head from the arm holding the staff.) This is what the above head fishtail should do. Ask Tim T&B about it. Reverse fishtail, behind head, in front and down.

8) To elbow wraps.
Rob style move. Can be done both ways, (forwards and reverse fishtail) but reverse is much easier. The reverse fishtail is going to go into an elbow wrap on the same side, and as it falls off the upper arm the other hand is going to catch it, reverse fishtail it to it's own side and do the same. The pulling across of the fishtail can be used to gather some speed you might lose in other parts of the move. Forwards is harder because you have push the staff up and over your opposite other arm. (Hard)

10) In and out of things.
You can pretty much fishtail to any move that involves the back of your hand, and out of any move involving the back of your hand. Fishtails and 180 turns can link up both directions of a movement also, which is cool for practise.

11) 360 fishtails.
Simple, just travel a 360 degree circle with the staff on the back of your hand. If there was a camera in front of you, having your arm high above your head when you have your back to the camera would make the move easier.

12) Fishtails what end behind your back.
I think you get the idea. I've just been playing around with these. Basically 180 fishtails where you don't turn and do something clever afterwards.

13) BTB fishtails.
Are possible, as are BTB fishtail passes.

14) Fishtails with extra beats due to retarded fishtails.
Fishtail, retarded fishtail, Fishtail. And so on.

15) Fishtails with throws. To hand changes.
You can do a little pop to swap hands. (Avoided that transition across your body that's really hard and just doing the easy one.) Or you can just use one hand with wee throws.

16) Horizontal.
Perfectly possible. the staff has to sweep down to your waist and then above your head. I can do them in reverse quite easterly, I haven't tried them forwards. (shorter staff probably mean less movement up and down.) You can use the lock against your hand to force the staff into the new plane.

17) Isolated and Anti-Spin Fishtails.
Anti spin fishtails are possible to do in a fountain style, i.e.: a continuous pattern of reverse fishtail, move to the other side of the

body, forwards fishtail. But it's very hard to keep the staff doing a clean anti-spin while fishtail, which is why this move is such horrendous fun.

18) Hand Positions for Fishtails.
There are many, the traditional on the back of the wrist fishtail. The similar but slightly harder on the back of the fingers fishtail. (knuckle tails). The fishtail on the side of the hand on the base of the thumb. The fishtail on the underside of the wrist. The fist-tail. The high fishtail on the pinky side of your hand. The fishtail on the inner side of your elbow, and maybe even the fishtail on the back of your neck....

The Elbow Family.
Or things to do with elbows....

1) The Conveyor Belt
This is a GREAT contact move. And has uber amounts of variations. So staff spinning in front of you, wall plane, slightly off-centre grip, in one hand, outward/forward. You're going to have the hand not holding the staff on the shoulder of the other arm and your elbow pointing directly in front of you, so that your arm and body make a nice horizontal triangle. You're going to spin the staff under this triangle and put the long side of the staff onto the upper arm of the triangle. The centre point should land in line with that big crease from your elbow. Once the staff wraps over to your forearm and is almost starting to fall off, you begin to straighten your arm out. (from the elbow obviously, how else?) The staff should wrap your forearm as you push it out and end on the wrist. (The staff you be about to fall off body side of your wrist), you do a simple pass to the other wrist (no gripping) and then do the movement in reverse. So it's on the other wrist spinning over it to fall off on the non-body side. As it's spinning over, bring your forearm in to create another triangle. As you do this the staff should wrap the upper arm and fall off the other side to be caught by the other hand. A mistake people commonly make on the second half is to immediately pull their arm in. The staff has to have it's leading end going down over the wrist as you're pulling the forearm in. Not to have the leading end coming down on the upper arm as you're pulling it in. This move it like two elbow wraps joined by a wrist transfer, but since it looks much nicer as a whole move, I'm going to refer to it as an The elbow wrapping move.

2) Entrances.
Lots of entrances to this one. Same hand as the first elbow wrap. (has to be done with an off-centre grip) So the staff comes under your armpit then up onto your upper arm to begin the move. Can also be done from the back of the hand, or from a shoulder wrap from the same arm as the elbow your are going to wrap first. Can be done from any way to get into a shoulder wrap.

3) Continuous using hand transfers.
After finishing the normal elbow wrapping, you can instead of catching it in a grip, you can catch it on the back of your other hand, do a hand wrap and swap it to the back of the other hand so that you can push it up onto the first arm and start the move all over again. So it would go... grip - elbow - hand - hand - elbow - hand - hand. (I use hand here, whereas I used wrist up in the first description but they mead the same thing.)

4) Elbow Pops
Elbow pops are arm pain fun. When the staff is on the triangle you made with your arm, throw it off so it does a quick half rotation, catch it again and throw again. These are elbow pops. I find that to avoid injury, I'm trying to match speed with the downwards staff, I catch it with the upper arm and the throw it off again with the forearm. I try to throw it as little as I need to, since it's a heavy bugger and I don't want to have to absorb too much bruise as it comes back down.

Also: pirouettes, that'll be fun!

5) Only elbows.
Don't want to bother about using the hand transfers? Well if you get that second elbow triangle into position very early. (practically at

the start of the trick) The staff wraps the first elbow, you don't move your hand out and the staff steps onto the second elbow and wraps that. This can be done continuously but trying to get the first elbow under the second, and so on. Takes a lot of shoulder and arm movement for it to work.

6) Two hands.
Instead of a normal hand wrap transition, you can place both hands side by side together under the staff and have the staff transfer that way. This makes the move a teensy bit faster, and can groove things up a bit.

7) With 360 fishtails in.
While doing a normal two hands elbow wrap, you get into the dynamic position of having the staff on the top of both your hands, here you can do a quick two handed 360 fishtail, (see the fishtail description) and come back to the same position as before, so you can continue the move to it's completion.

8) With confusatron style prayer moves in.
Two hands elbow wraps again. This time when your hands are together, bring them palms together, and do a devil stick style propeller with both hands, then continue the move as normal. You can do multiple propellers. Also you can do this in a more confusatron style, by using the other side of your forearms to support the staff more and do the propeller more slowly.

9) Places to use it. Side, BTB. Etc.
Yes indeed, you can do a single half elbow wrap (the second half, catching with the same hand) in the wheel plane, (to the side) or BTB. These will be useful to learn for other more monstrous contact moves.

Don't forget that I put BTB in the title of this move, you might want to try that too... and maybe BTH too? Would that work?

10) Layouts.
I say these on a baton twirling site. Quite mind-blowing and slightly weird.

Basically second half of the elbow wrap, but when your arms in the triangle and it's transitioning to the upper arm, the forearm comes around to straighten out to the side on you and the staff magically fishtails once down your arm (angel roll style) and you catch it in your hand.

You should make sure your palm is facing upwards as it rolls / angels down your arm, as this is correct technique. (!)

The reverse layout I find to be a bit easier: You start to do an angel roll, as the staff is coming in toward you, (it should be just above your elbow) you fold your hand in, and the staff should do a normal elbow wrap from there on. It does have a tendency to come toward your face. I find stepping back helps to begin with, till you learn how to control the momentum.

11) Elbow to back to elbow. (Decent recovery move.)
This is a completely different move not based on elbow wrapping at ALL. It is horizontal in fact.
Well I'll begin. The easy forced mostly plane breaking version of this move is to be holding the staff trapped in both your elbows. Let go with one and swing it behind you back and trap again there with both elbows. Let go again (This is more of a transfer) and bring it

back round to the front. This move can be done standing straight up. The next one should not.

Extra half turn on back version. Start in the same fashion, taking the staff trapped in your elbow to your back, bend forward and release the staff onto your back, let it do a half turn and it should naturally turn into your opposite armpit where you can grab it in the elbow trap and continue round to the front to get back where you started. Not so very exciting but a nice continuous move to practise. Then in an emergency, (A messed up Matrix for example) You can trap it in your elbow and do this move to get it to come nice again. Also you don't have to finish in the opposite elbow; the back release is very controlled and practically just by standing up you can get the staff to transition to your shoulder.

12) Elbow traps.
This is a lovely (non-mushy-pea) Steve move that I learned from knoxious. The staff is help trapped in the elbow joint. It's in front of your body, your elbow down, your hand up. The staff can only move horizontally a little before being stopped by your arm/body. Bop the staff (using the grip) so that it is moving away from your body. Before it is stopped by your arm, turn your arm and especially your forearm so the staff goes over your forearm and does a rotation on your arm before you catch it again in your elbow.
This is obviously very hard to describe. But it can also be done the other way. I also describe this in the shoulder section.

13) Elbow traps. BTB.
This is a vertical elbow trap. So you've got an off-centre grip, doing a forward figure of eight in the wheel plane. When it goes behind you, take it far behind and start to spin it into your opposite armpit, then trap it in your other elbow and bring it round to the front (With the aid of a lock between the elbow and your hand/forearm.) Once it's in front you can turn and go into the opposite direction trap immediately or instead do a small flick throw off your forearm and catch that. Or indeed you can just twirl it out of the elbow trap.

14) Elbow traps. Throws.
Horizontal throws from elbow traps. A nice way to get into a horizontal elbow trap is trapping it BTB.

15) Elbow traps. To Steve.
The number 12 elbow trap can easily be made to roll down your arm once it is on top of your arm, thusly doing a Steve. If you catch in your elbow on the other side, you can do the same thing again, but in the opposite direction. Also it has been rumoured that the staff could step across to the other elbow.

16) Elbow Fishtails (Fujimis)
This is a move directly from baton twirling and is EXTREMELY difficult. Yes you have to do a fishtail with the staff on that elbow triangle. No, you can't use your hand, no you don't have much movement with that elbow thing, yes it is going to fly off many many times.
So you do the elbow wrap that goes from your wrist to your elbow, the inward one that's the second half of the conveyor belt. Once it's up on that shoulder you can turn to the side of the arm it's on (which is the hard transition) or to ward the other arm, which is the easier transition.
After you've got both of them solid, all you have to do is link them up! Enjoy!.

The Halo Family.
Including the Angel Roll, The Pivot and The Jesus.

1) The Halo Roll.
The Halo Roll is quite simple. Spinning in reverse, wallplane, in the course of a normal figure of 8 the staff will spin behind you. At this point, bring the staff up and the centre to the back of your neck. No extra rotations to a normal F08, (No twisted up wrists or anything) just place it on the back of your neck. (You head doesn't have to be bent over for this, but it will feel like it helps.) Let go and it should roll (with spin) on your back, then you should turn body slightly so that it can roll over the shoulder it is heading toward. You should then find it is quite easy to grab and cradle in your armpit. After some practise the Halo roll can be done from armpit to armpit. It can even be done with out holding the staff while it is cradled in your armpit. You will need to twist your torso to get it to wrap over the first shoulder however. This will soon become second nature.

My own alternate explanation from when I had first learned the move:

To the proper trick: From the armpit, grip the stick (It's probably possible to do without holding it, but it'll take me a lot more practise.), carefully chuck it up toward your head, and place it between your shoulder blades, from there (with a little shoulder shimmy, nah joking.) it'll just fall nicely toward your other shoulder where you let it come slightly over the shoulder and catch the falling end in the armpit.

Obviously do this trick slow, else you will remove your head. It can also be practised from a reverse figure of eight, taking the stick behind you, barely letting it do a half spin before trying to stick it to the middle of your upper back, letting go, finding it doesn't stick, and catching with your other armpit.

Or alternatively: letting it go behind your shoulder and kind of pulling it back with a hand roll. (You'll see me do it in the video at random times.) It's either friction or a slight angle holding the stick to your back. Well I thought this before but now I think it's the curve at the top of your back which holds it on. Also - you'll notice I drop my head when the stick is on my back. This is unnecessary and I only do it out of habit.

Tips:

- Twist your body slightly so the staff rolls over your shoulder on the fall side.
- Do it at the right speed, too fast = hit you, too slow = fall off you.

2) Variations.
All of the below are variations. Three special ones of only the halo roll are:
Front Halo Roll. A Halo roll on the front of your body, instead of your back. Usually you wrap the opposite arm close to the shoulder and lean back to let it pass over the front of your body to wrap the other arm. Not generally done unless as a part of the JESUS.
Extra shoulder blade spins. Basically like an Angel roll squished onto your shoulder blade. Try not grabbing it as soon as possible and

keeping your shoulder tense, other than that I don't really know how I do it.
The most important variation, is continuous turning halo rolls. (Only Halo Rolls on the back.) The SNES helps with this move. Do a halo roll, turn 180 and duck your head, the staff should vertically wrap your neck. (SNES style) turn 180 again, do another halo roll. Continue. If you ask me this is a MONSTER roll!

> **Robs waist wrap variation. Here I am vaguely sure when he says back roll he is referring to a halo roll.**
>
> **waist wraps from back rolls. (please note waist wrap is a club swinging/poi term...)**
> **Do a basic back roll(vertical) but drop the opposite arm and catch BTB in the hand that let go. let the end following do a half circle in front on the opposite side, then return to start position.**

3) The Angel Roll.
This move is a baton twirling move. Basically it's a long arm Halo Roll. (The arms never bend.) But it's also like the opposite of a Steve.

So spinning in reverse, wall plane, arms out to either side of you, you're going to do a half reverse fishtail (going to the front of your body) and lift your arm to try and push it to your neck, halo roll, and keeping the other arm straight, let it step once down to your hand. The second part of this is easier.

So what happens is thus, raise your arm, let the staff ROLL down your arm to the elbow, this is the last time it'll be on the front of your body till it gets to the other elbow. It should step / roll to your back where the other end will partake in the halo roll, from then it'll continue across the back to the other elbow stepping there and hopefully continuing on to your other hand.

So this move has to travel your entire arm span. So it'll need some sideways momentum. To get this, you need to entire raise your arm so it rolls down, gaining momentum that way, and throw / push it out of your hand toward your elbow. I use the latter when I want to keep my arms horizontal and not raise them up.

4) The Jesus.
The Jesus is basically a front halo, to back halo to back halo.... continuously. Not soo very difficult in theory... in practise pretty hard. You can start this with a front or back halo, but I'll describe it starting with a front halo. Off-centre-ish grip, WHEELPLANE (V-Important) spinning inwards to wrap your arm close to the shoulder, you turn 90 degrees to get the staff to roll over your chest, 90 degrees while it rolls over your other arm, 90 degrees to get it to roll across your back, 90 degrees to get it to roll over the first arm again and sooo on. As you can tell this is a turning move. You MUST put the staff on in the wheel plane so that you turn into the movement, otherwise it will be a very hard trick to do.
The Jesus 900, may or may not be where you do front then back three times in a row.

5) Jesus Trident style.
You may have seen his video, he does a strange kind of Jesus with the front side halo roll as a non-contact move. He just keeps it quite far from his body and lets it transfer between his arms at about the elbow.

6) Jesus Throat wrap to Pivot.
Do a simple throat wrap and turn toward the staff to do a front side halo, then a backside. Quite easily once you've done a back halo roll you can go into the pivot. See it's description.

7) Places to put the Jesus.
Any place you can do a halo roll, you can start into a Jesus. Any time the staff is spinning vertically on your shoulder you can pretty much do some kind of halo....

8) The Pivot.
Simply the elbow wrapping move, but near the end, when the staff is on the far elbow, (and you have made sure it is very close to your neck before you decided to do a pivot....) you're going to turn away from that elbow (180 degrees) and your back should naturally be in place for a halo roll, then another 180 degrees and careful placement of your first elbow should bring you back to the start of the elbow wraps. So easily you can see it can be done continuously.
It can also be done horizontally. And in the vertical one, it can be done with one hand I think. (I think I have seen knoxious do this.)

> **A description of how to do/learn the pivot.**
>
> However you start, once it's onto your shoulder - Watch it, watching the staff is the easier way to know what the staff is doing, your shoulder doesn't have the same sensory equipment as your hands, yet, so use your eyes! Turn away from the staff, and basically keep turning, in as tight a circle as possible - taking the staff with you to timbucktu while doing a pivot is a) plane breaking, and b) looks crap. Try and get the staff in that sweet spot on your shoulder between your neck and your Medial Deltoid, and try and get it ending there as well.
>
> This move is a lot like a turning halo roll, and it can be a lot like a halo roll if you start the staff at a not quite so vertical position. So don't. The thing about the pivot to remember is: all you're trying to do with your body is stop the staff falling, so you position your body under the staffs pivot point, or centre.
>
> As ever: the faster the staff is going, the faster you turn. And then magically it's coming down over your shoulder and you're wondering what to do with it. Don't ask me, I haven't figured it out yet. You can see in the video, I'm like, going all gnarly with my elbows and head to try and keep it spinning. You might instead like to do the ending of an elbow roll to take it out, this is a much better way that I had forgotten in my rush for power and glory. (I forgot that one vital ingredient - the doll)
>
> **Tips:** Keep the shoulder up that you put it over originally, or keep the arm up, one or the other.

9) Pivot to Jesus.
The pivot is just a turning halo roll starting from elbow wraps. Any time you can do a halo roll you can go into the Jesus... You know what to do.

10) Throat wrap Pivot.
So far we have been using the halo roll to transition back to the first elbow in elbow wrapping. This time, we are either going to use a front side halo, (turn the opposite direction to a normal pivot) Or a throat wrap: turn the same way as a normal pivot but lean your head

back instead of forward and hope for the best. Throat side pivots can easily end up in face wraps. I generally hold onto the stick after the elbow wrap to make sure I'm completely happy about doing it.

11) Pivot from and to various types of elbow wrap.
The normal pivot, and possibly its variations can also be done from the variations of the elbow wraps, hands together being a bit harder, and no hands being the hardest. (Especially continuously.)

12) BTB straight on Pivot.
Another elbow wrap to halo roll move thing. So doing a BTB elbow wrap. (This comes in toward you're head) Instead of doing any other catches, you're going to do a proper elbow wrap and push it toward the middle of your back, where, of course, it will do a halo roll, for you to catch on the other side. (using another elbow wrap of course.) At this point you can transition to any other move you want especially more elbow ones. But also if you learn this move both ways, you can be sneaky and do a quick fishtail at the end of the move, while you turn 180 and do the move back the other way... and so on.

13) Angel Roll Variations.
Angel Rolls are remarkable like Steves. Except they aren't. But in many ways they are. Like in the way you can do many similar variations to the Steve with them. Horizontal Angel Rolls are possible and quite easy. You can also substitute a throat wrap instead of the halo in an angel roll. You can link them together with fishtails, like a pivot. (You can do all the same things with an angel as you can do with a pivot... it's just like a long arm version of a pivot.)

13.1) 4 Beat Angel Roll.
An Angel roll done with extra beat done on the shoulder blades.

14) Pivot Crossed with Angel Roll Variations.
The Pivot and the Jesus have an interesting relationship, partially suggested by the ability to use an angel roll in place of a halo. Well actually not suggested at all. Seems like it should be though...

Anyway, Try using an angel roll instead of a halo in every move you know...

The STEVE family.

1) The Steve. (named after mushy pea Steve. Not any other Steve.)
Staff starts off in a palm spin, rolls down your arm, wraps your neck, rolls up the other arm to end in a palm-spin on the other hand. To do Steve's continuously, all one has to do is transfer the stick back to the first hand. Ways I like to do this: as it rolls up the last forearm put the first forearm in the arm. Or throw it off the second forearm to catch on the first. Or a step transfer off the underside of the forearms, or a cool Not-mushy-Pea_Steve way of coming in with the first arm over the spinning staff and placing it on to that arm with the second arm.

My own alternate and slightly long-winded explanation of the move and how to learn it.

This is the 'Half Steve' move apparently. I like to call it a contact arm roll to neck wrap to contact arm roll, with an occasional extra turn on the back of the neck

move. But I might occasional use the shorter name...

To learn this move:

1. Learn the basic neck wrap.
2. Learn the neck wrap to arm contact roll [be sure you can do this in your sleep]
3. Learn the contact roll to neck wrap.
4. Learn the extra spin on the back of your neck from a basic neck wrap.
5. Put them all together - yay!

Some pointers on steps 1 and 2: Make sure the centre of the staff is dead centre on the back of your neck. If not - the staff has a fundamental need to roll crapply off your arm, underneath it (how you learn the monkey grab) or just plain jump off you. It might help to crouch slightly going into the neck wrap, gravity will still effect the staff after all. ;) On the arm roll, when the staff starts travelling further round your neck, that's when you know you've got good form. (When you can turn around with it on your shoulder and let it off to roll down your arm at will, you're just showing off. But that's a good goal.)

- Step 3: Hmmmm, the contact roll down your arm - toward YOUR FACE. It's such a high hand - clutching a heavy staff ready to come down and smack you in the jewels. AH!
  To explain this in the (looking upward) clockwise direction: you're going to do a left hand horizontal hand roll, but instead of it wrapping you're hand you don't let go of it quite quickly enough and let it go onto the side of your wrist. It's at an angle and spinning onto the top of your forearm. This letting go period isn't critical, but it will help if you get it right. It's not nice in the beginning, to let go of a spinning stick above your face, but you'll get used to it, or you'll get used to an ultra fast reflex elbow push off.
- Next the roll down your arm, this is critical, it won't fall over the inside of your arm happily, and if you chicken out, you can get it in an inner elbow grab and pop it out again.
  Anyway, the most important thing is; the angle it comes in toward your neck at, and whether the centre of the staff is going to be on the back of your neck. This is the nice bit: as the staff rolls down your arm, you can speed it up or slow it down by moving your arm up and down obviously to adjust the angle it comes into your neck at. Also you can pull your arm backward while the stick is on it to try and get the centring right. This is a full contact move after all, you can adjust it constantly while it's in contact with your arm! Yay!
- Then the neck wrap - same as always, it just feels different for some reason. (Probably because my arm rolls are imperfect)
- If you got a good angle incident to your neck and the wrap was good the staff should happily roll down your other arm and into happy helicopter land. Woot!
  It helps if you have kept the arm it's going to roll down out to the side, ready for it, and have that shoulder down too. This will help catch the staff when you f*ck up, and it will be easier to do it fast. [It's just like being ready for it.]
- Step 4: No contact roll to neck wrap here, just practise from an end grip.
- You are obviously going to have to duck your head to allow it to do a turn on the back of your neck. Watch the staff, WATCH IT, as it comes round to

try and bop your head. (Staffs like your head, that's why they try and touch them - DENIED!)
Then pop your head down and feel it do the turn, then pop your head up, the stick magically will be coming toward your head again, drop your shoulder to let it move into an arm roll. To keep it on the back of my neck I like to keep my shoulder up (my right one when clockwise) it helps it stay where I want it.

- At the last resort bringing your head up will prevent another spin even if the stick has to hit your head. (Don't worry, the stick likes that.) To me it feels like a strange collar bone push. Mostly you will notice if it hits your head.
- One thing it took me a while to realize: The faster you do this, the QUICKER YOU HAVE TO DUCK!
- Practise this till it becomes like an optional extra to a neck wrap. Easy to do, in other words.
- Step 5: Finally put the two previous steps together. This makes the back of neck spin feel really different, but just go back and practise with out an arm contact roll if you start to lose the move.
- In this move the downward arm roll has to be spot on, else you'll be doing the extra turn on the top of your back, and not your neck. (This can be recovered from thou.)
- Due to the different entrance to the move, the neck spin is a slightly different technique, (I have a tendency to let the stick bop me more when doing it like this. Alright, alright, I just like the word bop.) but ultimately learnable. (It's hard to describe the difference, it's more of a push with the neck to get the stick to roll down your arm.)
- Soon young Jedi, this move will gain it's own rhythm and you will be able to do it continuously and perfectly and fast and smoothly. And then you will finally feel HARDCORE.

Tips:

- On all neck wraps: on the exit side of a wrap, if it's still beside your neck and not further down your back, this is good.
- Strive to get your arm rolls on the top of your arm.
- Strive for the control that will let you let the staff wrap the front of your neck.
- If you can do this move in the light but not the dark, it's because you're sighting the centre of the staff on it's way down your arm, and you can't do that in the dark (duh!) I do this too. I know of no cure but the perennial - practise more in the dark. (Or get a glowing staff - yay I can see it!)
- This move is soooooo cool.

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An explanation of the Continuous Steve, here more correctly
referred to as the 'Continuous Half Steve'.
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As the staff is rolling down my end arm, it should have a decent amount of rotation left in it, I bring my other hand up underneath the other like it's pretending to be a plane. When the staff gets to about the middle of my forearm, and it's spun till it's almost pointing straight away from me, I drop the hand and roll it onto the other. (Sometimes if it has a lot of momentum it jumps off the end of my hand). On the other hand, if it has enough turning momentum, I bring my arm up to get some roll going and go into the next neck wrap.

Tips:
Sometimes the rotation is so fast, my hands aren't involved at all and I transfer between my forearms. This is fine, it's just quite close to your most important feature - your face. The rotation governs how long you can keep the move going. After a few [2 or 3] you will have to turn and start doing static half Steves.

When transferring in front, (this applies to large staffs - but why do contact with small?) It's basically doing a half turn in front of you, hence your hands/forearms have to be above your head: to avoid a burning brand passing in front of your face. If it stalls out on the hand you transferred it to, it hasn't got enough momentum to rotate to roll down your arm, move your body if you want to continue. - Usually a side step and turn.

2) Full Steve.
The above could also be called the 'Half Steve' But more often than not gets called the Steve and this gets called the full Steve. Basically, you do a Steve, and at the end, you either go into a palm spin and come back out down the other side of the arm, or do a horizontal hand wrap, to get it to come down the underside of your arm. (the underside obviously being held up at this point) The staff should wrap your throat (very hard, mine mostly steps to the other arm), roll up the underside of the other arm and into palm-spin. (And oh yes, you can do them continuously.)

3) Globetrotter.
Static version of the Steve. Holding arms up and out at shoulder height. The staff stationary balanced on the top of the hand. Staff rolls along arm, you duck your neck, rolls along other arm. Grab, done. A see saw would be if you could control the globetrotter enough so that the staff remained balanced and on the hand on the other side, so you could tilt the other way and the staff would go back to the first hand.

4) Static Steve.
Like the Globetrotter but more like a Steve. Start with the staff on the back of your hand, arm out in front of you. Staff rolls up arm, just before the neck, you turn quickly, (if staff rolling up left arm, you turn so that your back ends up to the left of your left arm.) 360 degrees, your neck wraps the staff and the staff ends up on the other arm, which it rolls down.

5) Vertical Steve.
Anything horizontal vertical can do too! Spinning, Inward shall we say, for the hand that's holding it. Staff wraps the hand, arm rises so that staff rolls down to the neck, vertically wraps neck and rolls off down the other arm.

6) Prayer Steve.
Horizontal Steve with the hands together. The trick is to get the centre point off your arm as it approaches your hands, so that it wraps with the centre point directly on the base of the pinkies, and the then comes round off centre onto the other arm. (some horizontal propellering is also useful here.) Then you can correct the centre point as it rolls down your arm for the next Steve.

7) Anti-Turn Steve.
Is not as nice as it sounds. Just turn into the staff as it does a cont Steve, you'll probably have to do two steves before you turn 260.

8) Chest Steve.
A Steve done so that instead of a neck wrap in the middle, the staff never goes onto your back and instead does a halo across your chest and then rolls down the other arm. The trick to this move is to transfer the staff to your chest as soon as possible. Like when it's at your elbow. Otherwise your REALLY going to have to lean far far back. Can be done continuously with practise.

Can also be done vertically.

9) Caged Steve.
When you've done a Steve and it's rolling down your ending arm, bring your other arm over it, and lower your other one and then bring your hands together, so now that staff is in a 'cage' made my the circle of your arms. You should be able to transfer it to the other hand, while low, but you won't be able to Steve normally, as they would require breaking the Steve. Instead if you turn, (or if your very good, without turning) in the direction of spin, you can do a Chest Steve and keep it in the cage. This can be done continuously. Like most Steves.

10) Single Beat Steve.
This Steve neither does a neck wrap nor a halo roll on the chest.
It's more like a spinning globetrotter.
Isolate it, if you have a small enough staff.

11) Cont. Vertical Steve. + from Elbow Wraps.
One can do the Vertical Steve Continuously. It's just a case of practise. The transfer is quite quick, but it's just a simple hand transfer.

Also as you extend the arm from an elbow wrap, as it move onto the wrist you can you get it to roll back down into a vertical Steve, and on the other side, once it reaches the end of the vertical Steve and is on the wrist, you can pull your hand back into the second elbow wrap of a conveyor belt.

12) Full Vertical Steve
You can do a Full Steve so obviously it must be possible to do a full Vertical Steve right? Yup!

The SNES Family.

1) The SNES. (Named since it wraps the **S**houlder, **NE**ck, **S**houlder.)
So, the SNES, or the Super Nintendo! Start with the stick spinning inward, wheel plane, with an off-centre grip. You're going to spin the staff under your arm into your armpit and do a shoulder wrap, then when the staff is horizontal (still spinning) on the top of your shoulder, you're going to start turning toward the staff and ducking your head under the side coming up so that it can wrap your neck. (The other side of the staff is falling off your shoulder) Once it has wrapped your neck , you're going to turn another 90 degrees and get that other shoulder under the staff so it can wrap it and fall off the back. You then grab the staff. Other variations: doing the first shoulder wrap with the other hand. (And correspondingly catching it with the other hand at the end.) Doing it without turning. You will need to turn your torso/shoulders though in order to do the shoulder wraps.

2) Add ons.
The SNES is great. But we just finished with the staff falling off the back of the shoulder... couldn't we do something from there? Yes, yes we could. You could add a halo roll on the end if you turned 180 degrees so that your back was underneath where the staff was going. Or you could do a 360 spin with the staff on the back of your neck doing something weird. Or your could do a halo roll to a Jesus. Or maybe some sort of BTB elbow thing... who knows?

3) Variations.
Incomplete SNES's involve doing a neck wrap to shoulder wrap or a shoulder wrap to neck wrap and stopping there. You can join these two up with a comedy grab and carry to other side of neck... You can do BTB throat side SNES's. The staff is wrapped on the shoulder from the other hand BTB into the armpit, then you lean back and let it wrap your neck, to catching it BTB with the opposite hand to shoulder.

3) Horizontal SNES.
The Horizontal SNES is surprising easy and kindoflike not-quite-a-matrix. The staff wraps the shoulder horizontally, then the neck then the other shoulder. Can also be done throat side in the same manner as the vertical one. With Horizontal SNES's it is also possibly to do extra spins on the back of the neck, or even full rotations around the neck.... Also you can miss out shoulders during horizontal SNES's passing it directly (Do not pass go) to the next one.

The staff can enter and exit with either hand.

4) The Sweep
This move is more it's own move. Horizontally spinning the spin outward, off-centre grip. The staff goes behind you and across you're back, there you lean away from it, (or toward the hand that's holding it) and let it go spinning up into the armpit, it wraps that shoulder a little, you straighten up and it wraps the throat to go on and wrap the other shoulder a little and falling off to be caught BTB.

Alternatively, the staff can go around the neck and do neck stuff at the end of this move.

This is a good starter move for Anti-Spin stuff. (Though it be quite hard...)

A couple of massive alternate explanations and 'how to learn' descriptions. One by me, one by someone else.

Shoulder-Neck-Shoulder variants.

There are three parts to this move, and two basic variants.

The three parts are:

The first shoulder wrap,

then the neck wrap,

then the final shoulder wrap.

All these parts are vertical. (at least for now.) The two basic variants are turning and non turning.

Non-turning - Just put the staff onto your shoulder in plane with your body (the wall plane). For the turning version - just stick in onto your shoulder in wheel plane. You'll find you have to turn in order to get you neck under it and to exit it nicely.

More variations: Throat wrapping! (Or: Hmmm, the back of my neck is developing callouses, time to get some on my throat too!) For me, this is something I haven't managed to make into a full move yet, but I can do all the component parts, so obviously it must be possible. Throat wraps: The staff starts out like you're going to do a halo roll over your back. i.e.: it's coming up to the back of your shoulder in reverse figure of 8. Instead of doing a halo roll, you stick your head back as far as it will go, look at the sky and think of bonny Scotland, then let the staff wrap your throat. (fun variations: do a throat wrap out of a elbow wrap, don't do a throat wrap, but place the staff on your shoulder and turn and carry it around your body, kind of like a half fishtail on your shoulder) So now it's wrapping your throat - yay! You can try plugging this in to your normal SNS (or STS now). (And yes, you can do throat wrapping with running. hmmm, turning....)

But why stop there? If we can have variations on the neck wrap part, surely we can have variations on the other parts? Of course! And there are sooo many.... Obviously the shoulder wraps are symmetrical. (for now) So some variations: Ben-ja-men does a nice job of starting a left shoulder roll with his left hand. He just spins it under his armpit and lets go - hey presto - shoulder wrap. I think knoxious does a nice shoulder wrap out of a elbow lock, I personally started off doing the left shoulder wrap by keeping my left arm straight and starting the wrap with my right arm putting the staff on my left shoulder. Other variations include: The right arm putting the staff under the left armpit from BTB. This feels more natural if you do a throat wrap out of it. (You might also consider catching the staff BTB at the end of the move) I can't think of any more shoulder wrap variations, if anybody has more, please do tell. And remember, these are not just different ways of starting a shoulder wrap, they are also different ways of finishing them!

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Asymmetric SNES:

First the easy cut-downs: Neck wrap to shoulder wrap. (Or why bother with the first shoulder wrap?) The more fun cut-down, shoulder wrap to neck wrap. This feels a bit odd, but it can be quite nice. This obviously leads to: Har har! Watch me orbit my neck with a staff! Do a shoulder wrap to neck wrap, catch the staff and pop it back on

the other side of your neck and complete the move: i.e. neck wrap to shoulder wrap. What jolly fun!

Next the super fast turny variant. Do the shoulder to neck bit, these instead of letting it come off your other shoulder, turn very fast. This turn should be in the direction of the shoulder your put the staff on first. (usually my left, so I turn to the left) This is a 360 turn, and keep your left arm straight. The end result should be that the staff doesn't go onto your right should but instead rewraps your left arm, (sometimes in a vertical Steve style) and you can catch in your left. (and start the whole move again! yay!)

Horizontal Variations: You could probably do all these moves, but horizontally. (don't quote me on that.) But for sure, the BTB shoulder wrap to throat wrap to shoulder wrap is a definitely well known horizontal move. I'm not sure what the other vertical variations would equate to when done horizontally, so answers on a postcard to....

Things to do after SNES: Jump up and down with joy! Or do a halo roll (you need to turn) And hey since you can do a halo roll, you can do everything that has the same starting position as a halo roll, and everything that joins a halo roll? Holy smoke, think of the possibilities batman!

one variation I do is from sns, turn like I'm going into a halo, but catch behind the back. When I first started, I wasn't able to twist my wrist enough to keep it spinning in the same direction so it stopped spinning. Dunno how to explain that one, but it does come with time. Pretty simple, but I'm still nu(and haven't progressed much since my fave contact stick broke)
I did get the horizontal version of this down before it did break, no interesting variations to share, with the exception of going all the way around the neck before onto the other shoulder, easier to do horizontally than vertically

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shoulder roll to neck roll to shoulder roll in vertical plane

Alternate explanation.

There is a reason why it is called contact staff, wear a beanie it cushions the blow a little bit. If you can practise somewhere in private wear a bike helmet you may feel a little silly but you will appreciate it when you cope a blow to the head.

Flow

The key to getting this move to work smoothly is to get the staff to be in constant contact with your body throughout the movement. If the staff bounces you will lose control of the movement.

Placement

Successful execution of this movement is dependant on the placement of the first shoulder roll as this determines the path the staff travels along for the moment. If the staffs middle (or close to) does not come in contact with the middle of the back of the neck during the neck roll the staff will either go shooting off or not go over.

First shoulder wrap

To get the first shoulder wrap smooth it is necessary to try and touch the point where the staff first contacts the shoulder, this will help prevent bouncing from occurring. While this is not essential the greater the distance from your hand to the contact point of the staff the harder it is to do smoothly. It is also very important that the shoulder wrap comes across the shoulder close to the neck. If the staff is to far away from your neck when it comes from your shoulder onto your neck it will fall onto your neck rather than rolling onto it

Holding the staff

The positioning of your hand on the staff will affect the path it travels, the correct position can be measured out by resting the staff on the back of the neck such that it is balanced. Then moving the staff backwards through the movement and catching it in the hand that will pass the staff into the move.

Smoothness

For the staff to move fluidly and not fast it is necessary to move your head in an arc and push the staff through using your neck. If you don't do this the staff will slow down as it comes over your neck plus it is more likely to hit your neck. To start with you need to look in the opposite direction to the shoulder you are going to pass the staff over. After the first end has past your head you then need to move your head so that you are looking to the ground and then to look to the other direction. Doing this as a single movement will make the move appear fluid.

Steps to learning the move

1. Practise doing a shoulder wrap by itself you will be able to feel when the staff passes over the shoulder correctly, you want it to be really close to your neck.

2. practise a neck wrap over the back of your neck with your head leaning forward and your body as upright as possible.

3. try passing the staff through the whole movement several times slowly while holding onto it so that you can feel where it will roll.

Doing the move

1. If you are holding the staff with your right hand you want to be looking to the left when you do the shoulder wrap (your feet are facing forward) and do the shoulder wrap

2. As the staff passes in front of you, sweep your neck from the left to facing down in an arc

3. As the staff rolls over your neck continue swinging your neck in the arc and let the staff roll over your other shoulder. your head should now be facing the right and your feet should not have moved.

Variations

The move can also be done starting the staff in the side wall plane and moving your body 90 degrees after the first shoulder roll for the neck roll

Ending the movement

Sometimes the staff can roll up your arm when you come out of the second shoulder roll if you bring your arm around straight. This happens because the staff is rolling along your shoulder muscle and then continues rolling along your arm. To fix this problem turn into the staff more so that your turning forces the staff of finish the move. Alternatively you can have your arms up on an angel such that a nook is formed between your arm and shoulder for the staff to rotate in such that it cant roll along the arm.

5) Mutant SNES's.

Now comes the weird bit. The SNES is pretty much defined by the whole should neck shoulder thing. Well, we're going to break that and go something else instead of the Neck bit, but keeping the three part feeling.

One thing to put in place of the neck wrap is a frontside halo roll. So it wraps your shoulder, you very quickly do a halo and swipe your face across the stick. (leaning slightly back) and then shoulder wrap on the other side and your away!

A variation on a sweep, that is exactly like a horizontal BTB entry and exit halo roll... cos it is a BTB entry and exit halo roll. Coming in from BTB as if you were entering a sweep, instead of a throat wrap let the staff do a halo and then catch it BTB the back like normal.

6) Missing Shoulders

In the SNES and the Sweep you can 'miss out' a shoulder so that the path of the staff is more: entrance, neck, shoulder, exit. Or: Entrance, shoulder, neck, exit. Vertically this usually requires just a little bit of forethought to make sure your head is out of the way. Horizontally it's a bit harder, as the centre point has to travel further while not supported by your body. It's a good fun way to mess with your contact moves thou.

7) Anti-Turn Sweep

The Anti-Turn Sweep is a very simple and nice anti-turn movement. Start to do a normal sweep, and when it's about to do the throat wrap part, turn into it, that is to say toward the shoulder that the staff is coming from. It'll wrap your neck very quickly. Let the staff continue onto the back of your neck. Now the trick is to keep turning, let it do an anti-turn neck spin and then take it off with the other arm, facing the way your started. Yummy.

8) Elbow Lock Entrance

Mentioned here for completeness sake. You can also enter a SNES using the elbow lock method described in both the elbow and shoulder wrap section.

The Matrix Family.

1) The Matrix. (After invention of another matrix, referred to as, The Rob Matrix or The Rob, to avoid confusion.)
After completing the first half of the matrix (see below) the staff wraps the back of your neck onto the other should where it can immediately go into the second half of the matrix. This can be done continuously, by doing a throat wrap on the front side, then you're on the correct should to start the matrix again.

> **Here Rob Himself explains how to do the matrix, using the Steve to get the staff to his shoulder and away from it again.**
>
> **matrix Steve**
> Staff spinning horizontally, anticlockwise in left hand.
> Begin the Steve. when the staff reaches the near side of the neck lean right and lift your left arm. the lift must be circular(also anticlockwise). the staff will return to the near side of your neck. continue round the back of the neck to the right side. lean left and lift your right arm. this brings the staff around your right shoulder and back to the right side of your neck. form here you can either complete the Steve or continue with any neck variation you wish.
> One hint for this is to begin slightly off centre so the first shoulder revolution has a bit more staff leading into it. otherwise you HAVE to be perfect and seriously stretchy. which by the way you should definitely do (stretch that is) before attempting this move.

2) Andre Matrix.
Slightly different to the Rob Matrix, can dodge three quick bullets with this matrix, rather than two spaced out ones. You do the first half of the matrix, but instead of the staff ending on the should of the rotating arm, the staff lands on the middle of the back, from there you do the second half of the matrix. (This is slightly easier as the staff is in an easier position) This too can be done continuously. You can do a front side Andre (with a lot of leaning back) or do a throat wrap on the front side. (a more Rob matrix style transfer). Anti-spin and spin work well with Matrices.

3) 1st Half Description.
The staff is rotating horizontally, inward. You place it on the top of your other shoulder, the centre slightly to the front. You're leaning as if to do a side stretch for the shoulder you placed it on at this point. (Well halfway into the lean) The staff should rotate to get into your armpit, give it a little push to their and let go. The side of your body should be horizontal now, your hand pointed to the stars and you're beginning to lean forward. Your arm is going to go in a big forward circle as you stop leaning to the side and start leaning forward / straightening up. (depending on the matrix) Straighten up, complete all body moves and the staff should end on the shoulder again of the arm you put it on.

4) 2nd Half Description.
Basically the opposite of the first half. But I'll explain. Do a normal neck wrap, as the staff wraps the neck and lands on the far shoulder start leaning baby! You will have to lean to the side and then to the back. (Stretch and warm up before you do this!) You arm will again point to the stars. But this time the arm goes in a big backward circle. The staff goes onto the side of the body rotates around the armpit and ends on the far shoulder. Basically with either half of the matrix the staff is doing a complete rotation around your arm/pit. The second half is a little harder, what with the staff

coming directly toward your face. LEAN MORE!

5) Meghan Offspring Matrices.
In previous matrices we have the 1st ending on the same shoulder or on the middle of the back. What about if we just skipped that first shoulder and had it landing on the far shoulder? This would be a Bastard offspring of the Rob and Andre Matrix, or a Meghan matrix. There are four variants for each direction. 1st half, lands on near shoulder, skips directly to the underside part of the 2nd half. 2, lands on far shoulder from 1st half and does a normal 2nd half. These variants can also be done on the front side.

6) Double rotations around the leading side.
This is sooooo cool! If only I could do it.... Anyway, you read above in the first half that the staff ended up on the same shoulder you placed it on to begin with... maybe you thought, why can't I just do the first half of the matrix again then? You can! With some small amount of difficulty....

7) Various Entrance variations.
So we read about placing it on the shoulder. With skill and practise any point the staff is horizontally spinning in the correct direction on the shoulder, you can do a matrix. Trust me, you can. Sweep to... Matrix. Steve to... Matrix, neck lock to... Matrix. You get the idea.

8) Steve Matrix.
This is getting a new section since I have some useful info for learning it. Well it kinda applies to all matrix entrances.

The centre point HAS to be in front of your arm, NOT on it. About 4-5 inches in front for me. This is what gets the staff around the arm-pit.

9) Anti-Turn Matrix.
Just what it says on the tin. Surprisingly easy actually, as the turn into it speeds the staff up in respect to you and it doesn't stay underneath the armpit for so long, so the leaning over part is sorter and easier.

I have to do two matrices in a row to turn a full 360, but I think if you turn fast enough, you can get around with just one.

10) Steve Andre Matrix.
Weird Variation inspired by Sandy one day. Do the first arm of the Steve, when it's getting down to your shoulder, really torque it around onto your back (not back of neck, it's not doing a neck wrap) and start the exit lean from an Andre matrix. If you're lucky and bendy, it should come out. From there you can do the opposite side of the Andre Matrix and then exit to a Steve again.

11) Multiple Arm Propellers.
The tricky bit of the matrix is the bit where it goes around your arm horizontally. The easy bit is the transfer to the other side. Sooooo, like why not do the hard bit a few more times? Just to show off? Baton Twirlers and Rob can do this. It takes some quick whirling of the arm, and having the staff even more off-centre than normal to accomplish.

The staff does have a tendency to fly up your arm, so if it does, catch it up there, before it falls back down, that would be a BAD thing to happen.

12) Cont Matrices.

matrices where you just keep going and going. Try and get the staff to land or roll a little way down your arm, so you have something to whirl it around with to speed it up fractionally, so you can keep going and going.

12) Substitute Matrix.
Not what it sounds like, as it is in fact far harder than a matrix. You might have been reading this and noticed that many times you can substitute a halo roll for a throat wrap, and similarly you can substitute a neck wrap for a chest halo roll. Soooooo, maybe you can do that in a matrix too? Yes, yes you can, but it's very very hard, as it involves yet more leaning, and a very awkward ducking under of the head.

Static Moves.

1) Static Steve.
See the Steve Section. (Sorry, I hate people that say that.)

2) Isolations.
Mime style: pretend to keep the staff still.
Harder style: Keep a point of the staff isolated that isn't it's centre.
Weird Style: Keep your hands isolated.
Illusion style: Move your hands over the staff without the staff moving.

3) Globetrotter.
Balance staff on hand, let it roll up arm, across shoulders (duck head) down the other arm and catch. (Arms straight out to either side of you.)

4) Neck pinches.
See the Neck wrap section.

5) Baton twirling side body rolls.
The one I know, one arm high in air with staff, leaning to the side so that your body and underarm makes a straight line, let the staff roll down your body and catch BTB with the other hand.

6) Back up the way side body rolls.
Grip the staff between your body and forearm, rip the staff up your body like your doing a burn off and lean to the side, hopefully the staff should travel up your body and arm and land in your hand, at which point, you should smile cheekily.

Drops.

1) BTB drops.
Spin the staff, wallplane, reverse, as much as possible behind your head so it locks into your arm. Then drop it to the other hand waiting below. Tasty!

2) BTB catches after drops to immediate contact move.
I love Andre. Though this does have immediate flavours of baton twirling about it, and seems quite related to Antti's BTB stoppers. Do a contact move, like a shoulder wrap, as it falls, catch it behind the back with the other hand, but immediately transfer it back into a contact move on the first arm. Very Nice Indeed.

Teeth.

Yes you can grab the staff in your teeth. (don't use your tongue, the staff will take icky. (Paraffin and sweat together at last!)) I'm sure if you're interested in doing tooth grabs, you can work them out yourself. Basically once you've bit it, you can only carry it around in your month, I doubt your tongue is quick dexterous enough to manipulate it.

Contact Throws and Catches.

1) Contact throws.
Contact throws can come off any body part which you can move in a throwy kind of manner. I'm sure you can imagine which ones. My

personal favourate has got to be a back of the neck throw or a shoulder throw. Both of which I would like to refer to as 'pops'.

2) Contact catches.
Not harder to do than contact throws, just more likely to result in pain. I would suggest matching speed with the staff, and thicker clothing for learning these. Prototypical catches: Into a Steve from horizontal or vertical throw.

3) Back of Neck catches - vertical + horizontal.
A particularly nice way to get it on the back of your neck if you can do it. Horizontal easier than vertical, only because with vertical you have to be mental to do it. And that means you mo-seph!

4) Other ideas: (From the homeofPoi contact thread - YAY!)

Contact Catches

fishtail, throw,
Catch back in fishtail. pirouette catch in fishtail

horizontal catch into steve
Horizontal throw(in my case i prefer right hand throw here, spinning anti-c, and passing across/above the body to the left hand)catch the staff on the outside of your hand so as to start the steve...

elbow to elbow throws
Think i described these in my contact thread a while ago, they involve trapping the staff on the inside of an elbow, then releasing it by straightening your arm. this can throw the staff either to the opposite elbow or come back to the same one.

outside of elbow to outside of elbow.....(hint, try out of a steve)
I guess this is a sort of a variation and an obvious one of the horizontal catch into steve. you described the one from hand to the other. and you can do it keeping the staff in one hand for a few throws and catches and then to the other for example.

And i've been doing the BTB stoppers seen on Soy on everything part II (video) with catching the staff on the back of my hand and changing it's direction from there.

I'm quite into an alternating hands fishtail pattern - let the staff do half a rotation on the back of one wrist, then flick it up and catch it on the other wrist, and it does half a rotation, and then back again. You can do it so that you catch the stick on the same side as your arm then throw it when your hand has crossed your body, or you can catch across the body and pull it back to the same side.

While spinning a rotor on the backs of your hands, toss it up and catch it again on the back of hand again, from there turn 90 degrees and go into a fish tail

From the half steve instead of just a little flick off the arm give it a bit of hight so it spins 2 or 3 times then catch it into a steve (not that imaginative but

grate fun). Another one on the same theme is roll it down the front of the leg into a trap between foot and shin then give it a kick and get it to spin horzontally in the oppsite direction and catch into a steve.

Other.

1) Spinning with feet.
You guessed it, Miss Bernadette's foot juggling, but with a staff. Plus it's much like doing continuous hand wraps, but with your feet. (You will both feet free to do this.)

2) Big acro moves with staff trapped in a joint / pinch, carried on back of neck or help in hand. (Cos acro moves are hard enough without involving contact.)
Acro moves I have seen: Hand stand with staff balanced and slightly pinched in back of neck, cartwheel with the same, one handed cartwheel with the same.
One handed cartwheel with staff held in far hand - vertical spinning, one handed cartwheel with the staff help in near hand - horizontal spinning.
Normal cartwheel, staff resting on first foot, staff flies into air, cartwheel stops, arm catches staff.
Finally: That capoeira move which is a cross between a backwards cartwheel and a back-spring/flic-flac. This time that staff is help in a neck pinch. Ask Kyle about them.

3) Illusions.
There are two meaning in staff for illusions. One is a type of acrobatic move that baton-twirlers do which involves a turning backwards high kick, with a throw caught or throw between the legs in the middle of the kick. Or my version which is a move that looks like it should be a contact move but actually isn't. (Hence the illusion.)
All Illusions are 1 beat spins while turning, so you would have the staff spinning horizontally, you would make to put it on your shoulder, but actually keep hold of it, turn while it's doing it's little 1 beat spin, and when you're done turning, release it into a contact move, or take it off your shoulder and spin normally.
Basically all the staff is doing is wobbling up and down while you are spinning. But it looks impressive. Can be done all directions etc etc etc....

4) Foot and leg contact.
I don't personally do much foot and leg stuff. I might be getting into it soon. But I don't think I'll be doing any under the leg stuff.
Some people also think that elbow wraps can be done with legs, (and indeed they can) I imagine more will follow from such imaginings.

I would recommend the lynx for good looking-ness, but then I've never seen any of the others.... Anyway, enough about me:

foot reversal

Staff in right hand, horizontal anticlockwise.

Throw(drop!) the staff down the left side of your left leg. and lift your right foot up to horixontal(bending at the knee) and trap the staff between knee and foot. just give your leg a little shake and the staff comes out in the opposite direction...

Foot Work

The Mullen

The basic idea behind this trick is to catch a vertically spinning staff on your foot, turn it horizontal for one full rotation, then turn it back vertical and flick it back into your hand.

To do this you need to be able to do a few things...
1) Balance on one leg for a long time
2) Foot stalls and general foot balancage. If you can catch and throw a horizontal staff without making it spin, it makes learning the transition easier.
3) Foot helicopters. ie, continuous throwing and catching a horizontally spinning staff on your foot. Anticlockwise for the purpose of this description, because it's easier on the right foot.
4) Foot fishtails are useful, but not essential. If you can do them, you'll already know most of the foot positions needed

I'll start by describing the slightly easier half-mullen.

Start with the staff spinning forwards in the right hand, side plane.
Let the staff roll off your right hand, and stall it on your right foot. Aim to catch it so the centre of the staff lands on your ankle.
Twist your right foot a little to the left, and the staff should rotate horizontally, balanced on your foot. At the same time turn your hips to the left.
When the staff has rotated 180' and you've turned a little, the staff should be against your right calf. Kick the staff up with your right foot, and it should crank around your calf, and come up spinning vertically. Finish turning to the left so you've turned your body 180' , and the staff should be spinning forwards, in your right hand.

Variations: Don't turn all the way around, and catch in the left hand instead, or do it wall plane, so you start with the staff behind you, horizontal spin to the side, kick up in front. (or kick in such a way that it jumps up behind you again into your right hand

A mullen is this same move, but with a foot helicopter in to get the full 360' horizontal spin. There's two ways of doing the foot helicopter kick, one where the staff is kicked up to spin over the thigh (easier), and one where you let the staff stay under your thigh and whip your foot around to catch it (much harder…)

A swap-mullen is where you catch the foot heli on your other foot, which means if you start wall plane with the staff behind you in your right hand, you come out facing the other way, with the staff behind you in your left hand.

The hard part to make look good is the plane change… It's easy enough to stall the staff and then spin it sideways, but it's much nicer to catch it earlier and use your toes to start the horizontal spin, so there's no pause.

Next, there's the Inverted mullen entry, so called because you enter the move

from an inverted foot stall, and have to use the hard helicopter kick, which I reckon ought to be called inverted as well.

First of all: An inverted stall is a stall under a body part, such as your arm or leg. I'm using inverted to mean that the staff passes between the controlling hand (or foot) and your body (or the ground), like in inverted poi moves.
To do one on your hand, stall an anticlockwise spinning staff on your right hand, then turn the staff 180' anticlockwise, while remaining in contact with the staff. You have to reach over and around the staff to do it. You could also do one by rolling forwards over your bicep and stalling on your hand, but the description of the first one is needed, because you have to do that on your foot. You end up with the staff horizontal, between your legs, pointing front to back.

Right, so an inverted mullen entry starts like that, then to get it spinning horizontally, I currently just manoeuvre the staff against my left leg and push, but the smooth toe curl is getting there… Once it's spinning horizontally, you need to do an inverted helicopter kick, and catch on the same foot. After that, it's back to the normal mullen exit. I'm sure an inverted exit is possible, but inverted kick to inverted catch is not going to be easy.

You ought to be able to get an inverted horizontal spin to roll up onto your ankle and uninvert, like you can with inverted fishtails on your wrist, and then do the normal heli kick, for super sickness. Then you could catch and invert, rather than trying to catch inverted. Hmmm.

So basicly, the mullen is the entry and the exit, and there's room to insert other horizontal moves in the heli. A palm spin looks good… Head spin'd look better. Swap mullen with a headspin. Mmm…

The Lynx

1 Staff Contact
With your feet!
Difficulty rating 6.7 out of 11* (but worth it)
Wordy description, but that's contact for you… I'll be amazed if anyone can understand this.

1) Stand –feet a bit wider than hip width, plant your staff vertically in the ground on your centreline a bit in front of your toes. Right hand holding the top of the staff.
2) Lift up your left leg so that the staff is against your left inner thigh. Wrap your foot around the staff (clockwise) so that the back of your ankle is on the staff handle.

The staff hasn't moved yet, so maybe you're beginning to wonder what the fek is going, on, its ok, it gets good real soon.

3) Simply(!) Push inwards with your left thigh and outwards with your left ankle, and turn your body 1/2 turn to the right (180deg Clockwise) on your right foot, so that the staff rolls over the back of your left ankle (3/4 revolution clockwise in the juggling wall plane).

4) As the left foot goes down on the ground, the staff does another 1/2 turn so you can catch what started as the top end of the staff on the top of your left foot near the end, other end of the staff on the ground, pointing out to your left. (what was the right when you started)

5) Which sets you up for a nice standard kick up, and a catch back into spinning.

I don't normally name moves, but this one is called lynx, (unless someone else is already doing this, or knows it by another name??) kinda after the woman who inspired it.

Charles this is one of the ones I promised you a few months back, when I got my camera, I've got the camera (and had i fixed), but I still haven't got round to filming it. Duh, So for now you got to put up with deciphering words.

Not very complicated, or anything, but I like it.
Start a forward figure 8 type thing in the wall plane. When the staff comes in front of you, stick your leg out straight as if you were going to pass the staff underneath.
Feed the staff somewhere close to your knee and let it roll over the top of your leg.
Before the staff rolls all the way over, rotate your leg around the outside of your body and kick out backwards. The staff should be rotating over the back of your knee by this point.
When you kick out backwards, try to keep your leg as horizontal as possible. The staff should pop up behind you. Turn and catch it.
Keeping your leg horizontal on the kick should prevent you from launching your staff into your neighbours' garden

5) Body Rolls.
By this I mean any time the staff rolls off some body part over your torso or back and onto your leg to roll down your leg and onto your foot. You can do a long body roll down to your foot starting from your arm: Steve to your upper arm, let it roll down and across your you back and then down your leg.

Similarly down your leg from the horizontal BTB entrance to a Sweep.

You can do a neck wrap, let it roll down and across your chest and catch it BTB with your hand.

Also you can catch it at the waist with your knee, which is also fun.

And after all of these: Kick back up!

6) changing direction with your legs.
You can stop and change the direction with the staff with your legs, which is quite fun. Either using your toes, with the staff on your foot, or using your knee with the staff at your waist, or using your foot, with the staff almost held in the inside of your knee and the foot turned up behind you.
If you want you can then turn and let the staff roll down the body part, or if your bendy, raise your leg so much it runs up (which is now down) your leg and onto your body.

Advanced Concepts and Ways to create and link up movements.

So you've read this far have you? Time for some even more complicated staff chat!

First on the agenda: the interchangeable nature of the halo roll and the throat wrap.

Well that and the dual interchangeability of the chest halo roll and the neck wrap.

What has this got to do with anything? I hear you ask... well take any normal move, a SNES say, and change the neck wrap part to a chest halo roll and you have a new move! Excellent! And what's more this works for all movements, and in all planes!

But what if you want to substitute a neck wrap for a halo roll? Well, you can't. If you try to imagine it, in a SNES, the staff wraps over the shoulder and it has one end pointing down, toward your toes on the front of your body. then it does the neck wrap. If you wanted to halo roll here, imagine how a halo roll would want to start, the entirety of the staff would want to be behind you, so that one end could point down the centre of your spine. There's no easy way to get the staff in this position from the start of a SNES: a shoulder wrap. So you can't substitute it.

However a halo roll on the chest starts from a very similar position to the neck wrap, but does a half beat less than a neck wrap. (a beat being a full rotation, a half beat being a half rotation: switching ends of the staff.) The shoulder wrap comes over and instead of the staff facing down at one shoulder it points down in the middle of the chest then rolls over to the other shoulder. A chest halo roll.

See how it works? You'll have to imagine some of it, I can't do that for you.

Next: Linking moves that use the shoulders.

When a move ends on the shoulder, (I'm referring primarily to horizontal stuff here, but it also works in vertical, it's just a lot trickier.) that means you can link it to another movement that ends on the shoulder! You might think.... it's going the wrong direction... Sooo, you can turn, or you can stop it on the shoulder and go back the way you came and so on... Shoulders are extremely useful.

It's also fun to link up movements in a similar way on any other body parts.

Now: Steve's, Angel Rolls and Arm Rolls in general.